CHIC STAYS

THE HOTTEST NEW HOTEL OPENINGS IN INDIA



Raffles Jaipur

Elevating the luxury quotient of Jaipur is Raffles' new outpost near the magnificent Amer Fort. The brand's second property in India, after Udaipur, is a modern recreation of a palace. Hand-carved from white marble, it is a testament to Rajasthan's fine craftsmanship. The hotel features 50 opulent rooms and themed luxurious suites.

Doubles from Rs 40,000++; raffles.com/jaipur

Ronil Goa



MOHSIN TAHA

The first 'JdV by Hyatt' hotel in India and southwest Asia embodies the *joie de vivre* philosophy of the brand. The 135-room boutique resort is located on the Calangute-Baga Road, making it accessible from both the Dabolim and Mopa airports. With tastefully furnished rooms, the hotel invites visitors to experience the susegad way of life with two pools, an on-site DJ host, wellness services, and a variety of dining options. *Doubles from Rs 6,086 ++; hyatt.com*



Kinwani House, Narendra Nagar

Experience a blend of old-world charm and modern luxury in Kinwani House in Uttarakhand's Narendra Nagar, above Rishikesh and Haridwar. Once the home of a member of the erstwhile Tehri-Garhwal royal family, it has been painstakingly restored to its original grandeur and opened by the Aalia Collection by JPL Group. This estate has six luxurious suites affording scenic mountain views, besides lush gardens, a conservatory, and a temperature-controlled swimming pool.

Doubles from Rs 37,999++; aaliacollection.com

Geetika Sachdev

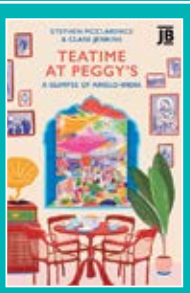
JOURNEYS INTO THE PAST

Two books that offer travel inspiration and unique cultural insights



Destination India: Foreign Artists in India 1857-1947
DAG
₹4,500; 175 pages

Published as a collector's edition catalogue for a new exhibition at DAG in Delhi, *Destination India* showcases the works of foreign artists who visited India from the Uprising of 1857 to Independence in 1947, highlighting a late phase of Orientalist art. Unlike earlier artists like William Hodges and the Daniells, who focused on picturesque landscapes and architecture, these later artists—Charles W. Bartlett, Edwin Lord Weeks, John Griffiths and Mary Anne Blyth among others—were more diverse and interested in depicting everyday life and society. They came from various countries, including Germany, France, Japan and Britain. With a Foreword by Shashi Tharoor and an Introduction by Pheroza Godrej, the book offers a personal and intimate view of India through the eyes of these foreign artists. ■



Teatime at Peggy's: A Glimpse of Anglo-India
By Stephen McClarence & Clare Jenkins
Journey Books
£9.99; 296 pages

Over 15 years, Stephen McClarence, an award-winning travel writer, and Clare Jenkins, a BBC Radio journalist, embarked on multiple journeys to the railway town of Jhansi in India to document the lives and traditions of its Anglo-Indian community. Their experiences culminated in this book that spotlights two memorable figures: 'Aunty' Peggy, a dedicated community leader and custodian of the European cemetery, and Captain Roy Abbott, the last British landowner in India, known as 'The Rajah of Jhansi'. Through their stories, the authors provide a warm and humorous portrayal of the Anglo-Indian way of life, which is rapidly disappearing. The book captures the essence of a fading culture framed within the vibrant chaos of 21st-century India. ■

Satarupa Paul